

(2026 update: I wrote this quite a while ago, and due to everything happening in the world right now, I thought it fit to include warning markers (!!)) in case you're sensitive to that sort of thing)

So, since the FNAF 2 movie released, I've been hearing a lot of people saying that the FNAF storyline is basically unsolvable and messed up and not even that good of a story anymore. And while I disagree on a larger front, considering how much Scott inspires me, and how much I've thought about this narrative throughout my 17 years of living, I have slowly begun to agree more and more over time. Taking out the fact that I have been a fan of this franchise basically since it came out, and literally can't criticize it since it has made such a huge impact on my life as a whole, I have, more or less, thoroughly analyzed FNAF as a continuous narrative, and.....I totally see it. The main problem, I think, is William Afton himself. You probably have heard this by now, but this guy went from a supernatural horrific killing machine whose living actions will always affect people and things to an angry British mad scientist who can't die whatsoever and is probably living off of super glue and Benadryl. And yes, I know the mimic exists, we'll get to that. And even though I love Sister Location overall as a game, I don't like the implications of what it does to Afton's character. I also think the Henry Emily story could have been better, and more expanded upon.

Kind of an unpopular opinion, but I don't mind Afton becoming a virus. I find the idea of a serial killer living through technology and AI is fascinating. (and yes, I also like the mimic; I think it could be a really good character if Scott and Steel Wool do it right in the upcoming game.) The way the storyline is presented, however, is not at all well-paced, but that's mostly because Scott had no plan for the story and how it would work. But what if he did have a plan? How would it turn out if I kept most of the original story but just made it a lot better? So, after researching a BUNCH of other people's rewrites, I think it's finally time to do my own.

WARNING: This story contains gore, violence, child abuse, and theming of intrusive thoughts, and insanity. Please proceed with caution.

It all started way back in Hurricane Utah, in the early 80s, with a man named Henry Emily, the founder of Fazbear Entertainment Inc. Henry was a mechanic who started the company back in 1977, and after some money and collateral dealing, he opened up his first restaurant, Fredbear's family diner, a year after he established the company. Henry has been a huge admirer of the traveling circus ever since he was a little kid. He would always go to the Fallfest with his parents, an annual circus tradition in Hurricane. After getting a master's engineering degree from UC Berkeley, he even managed to run the circus for a while. The thing he was always most interested in, aside from the pizza (he loved pizza) was the puppets they used, like marionettes on strings. Henry wondered if they would be able to move without the strings attached to them. Well, after a trip to Disneyland (and after seeing the ride "Great Moments with Mr Lincoln), he quickly realized that this was it. Machines that could move, like puppets on a string, but the strings were replaced with mechanical wiring. In the end, he thought up Fredbear's as an automated circus. where animatronics could entertain and sing songs, just like show runners performing, while also serving up fresh pizza and drinks. But most of all, he thought of Fredbear's as a place where people could be happy. That's what made him fall in

love with the circus. It brought people together for entertainment. Needless to say, it was a massive success (I also want to point out that these animatronics were very bare bones. Just simple animatronics with electrical boxes sticking out, much like the mediocre melodies in pizzeria simulator). People were fooled by the animatronics, thinking there were people inside. They were in awe of just how fluid the animatronics moved; some even claimed the animatronics, Fredbear, and Bonnie, had so much fun onstage they actually "came alive." Henry thought that was catchy. "Where fantasy and fun come to life." And the price, honestly, couldn't be better. For just 7 dollars a pop, you could watch a bear and a bunny sing and dance; plus, for only 56 cents extra, you could get half a pizza and a drink. Needless to say, Henry had substantial wealth, while making lots of people laugh and smile. Not to mention that he now had a loving wife and a kid named Charlie, whom he loved more than anything else. So much so that he made a puppet animatronic for her. She loved puppets, too. Henry thought it ran the family! And that's how it could have ended. A perfect ending. A simple little tale about a bear, a bunny, the circus, and a man who loved laughter and ingenuity, but instead, he wanted to make it grow. And that turned into a mistake that cost him so many lives.

Flash forward to 1979; Henry partnered with Murray's Costume Manor to create a new restaurant, Freddy Fazbear's Pizza, connected to Fredbear's, but with new mascots, Freddy the Bear, Bonnie the Bunny, Chica the Chicken, and Foxy the Pirate Fox. And not just a single restaurant either. With a bigger budget, not only did he already have 2 location spots spread out around Hurricane, he was planning to have it countrywide. He even made a deal with ABC to have a cartoon based on his characters. He had so many ideas, making exclusive animatronics in each restaurant for birthday parties and shipping the animatronics to different restaurants so the guests had a different experience each time. He was ecstatic about the future, and he needed someone to handle his plays, which led him to the most important change. He now had a business partner, by the name of William Afton.

To say Afton was a close friend to Henry was an understatement. They were practically brothers. They worked together at Fall Fest, they both graduated from UC Berkeley with the same degree, so he knew very well how animatronics worked and even made his own, and their families were inseparable. However, they were still different people. Henry was soft spoken, and quiet, while Afton was loud, and sometimes quite ignorant, and egotistical, though Henry didn't let that deter him, he was still extremely loyal to those we cared about. Their view of their creations differed as well. While Henry mainly desired to make people happy, Afton was all about the economic, and technological aspect of it. He would run wild with ideas about how the animatronics could be improved, and it helped that they were both mechanics for them. During this time, Afton created new suits of Fredbear, and Bonnie that could double as both animatronic and suits. not to mention that they were very well constructed, with spring locks that open up, have a lock that snap them into place to not crush the wearer, and even bend to the wearer's needs. He thought it was an amazing marketing ploy, that parents could pay a little extra to have a more personalized experience with the animatronics. Nonetheless, Henry was impressed. In spite of his ego, It was a sure thought that Afton was a genius, Not to mention he had three children and a beautiful wife whom he loved almost obsessively. Afton also worked as a security guard, to earn some extra cash, even though he was paying the bills with no problem.

Life was good to Afton, and he showed it. Much like Henry, Afton loved kids, considering he had three of them. He would even operate the Bonnie springlock suit himself from time to time. Bonnie was his favorite. Yeah, life was good. Until it wasn't. One fateful night, after a night of heavy drinking with his wife, rather irresponsibly on Afton's part, the drive home resulted in a horrible car crash, killing her. But Afton survived, though only just. A piece of the car has been lodged in his frontal lobe, specifically the Ventromedial prefrontal cortex, the part of the brain that determines moral judgment, as well as other parts that were at least fractured. Afton still survived, and the last thing he saw was his beautiful wife's head, hair burnt, both eyes impaled. He believed it was a punishment from God for acting so frivolous, and he felt betrayed. And from all these injuries, sadness, and agony, a new Afton was born, one of uncontrollable anger, grieving, and wrath. On this day, The rabbit was born.

Henry was worried for his friend. Afton barely showed up anymore outside of dealing with their finances and rarely talked to him. In the first month, Henry left him be, he was grieving, it's natural. But after 7 months, he was beginning to worry. He learned from Afton's oldest son, Micheal, that he had gone violent and loud and had excessive drinking problems at the pub. His younger brother, David, was heard crying, night and day, and when he wasn't, he was speaking to someone in his room, alone. His brother also was having violent night terrors, though Micheal knew nothing else. Henry wished that he could help, but he was too preoccupied with everything going on. That was until October 6th, when Afton's younger son was killed. Micheal and his friends were bullying David at Fredbear's, and it got too far when they made David give Fredbear a "big kiss." Michael heavily discouraged this, but it was too late. The springlocks inside the suit were very weak against liquid, and with David crying, Fredbear's jaw snapped shut. Fredbear's was closed indefinitely. David was in the hospital for several days, until finally dying in his father's arms. Henry was shocked when he heard this. Not Davey. He loved Afton's kids as much as he did his own. This was..... unimaginable.

Two years later. If Afton wasn't aggressive before, he was now. He was constantly beating Michael to the point where the marks looked almost purple. As much as he hated to admit it, Henry's best friend was starting to scare him. This wasn't regular behavior for Afton. He was barely angry. On top of that, the number of missing children's cases in Hurricane was skyrocketing, Freddy's was falling out of relevancy, and he still barely saw his business partner at all. Henry had his suspicions about Afton, as the culprit of these murders was a "thing with rabbit ears." Henry immediately thought of the suits Afton made for him. However, he just assumed he was overthinking. Eventually, the stress got to him and he thought he would talk this over with him. At the very least, he needed to make sure his friend wasn't going insane. So he went to Afton's house and asked him about everything, and he replied that he knew nothing about the missing children, aside from reading it in the paper that morning, that he was seeking therapy for his wife, and son, and that he was doing well, and more than happy to continue working. Content, Henry told Afton his regards and headed off. Afton was a good liar.

On the 21st of June, 1985, five children thought they were going to have a happy day hanging out with their favorite animatronic friends and eating delicious pizza, but little did they know it

would become a day that they would never forget. They saw the rabbit, Bonnie. He lured them into the safe room, sometimes offering cake, or just a hug, or even a lost puppy. The only thing he gave them was pain.

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The first was Susie, she will never eat again, nor shall she attempt it. The next was Fritz, and he couldn't hear his own screams, or feel his own left hand. Gabriel, the least scarred, and the happiest, too. and Jeremy. Sweet Jeremy, he had such a nice face. The last was Cassidy. She's in the old Fredbear suit moved to the safe room of Freddy's. And yet, Cassidy is gone.

Freddy's was closed. The children's parents notified the police after not being able to find their children, and the security cameras revealed that the culprit was a man in a yellow Bonnie outfit who was on location that day. After police searched the original Fredbear's location, all they found was a message scrawled across the stage. "You can't." After this, Henry was paranoid. His dream of making kids happy was falling to the ground. In a state of horror, and trauma, He fired Afton. The risk was too great. He got sacked the next morning, with no word other than to "work on your mental health if you want it back". Henry knew in his heart that it was Afton who was doing this, but he couldn't bring himself to turn him into the police, nor was there enough evidence. They never found the children's bodies. What's worse, he was being blamed for this. But all of that was just an afterthought to him. He was just hoping, praying that it wasn't his friend.

Afton stared at the termination paper at the bar. How could he? Henry was his friend, his colleague, and his most important business partner! His mental health was fine! Those were Henry's robots, HIS characters that killed his son! He doesn't owe a single shit to Henry! Afton, in a drunken rage, drove over to Freddy's, and to his surprise, Henry's daughter, Charlie, was outside in the rain, looking into Freddy's. That shy, creative girl, who always carried Henry's "spark" of bringing joy, stood vulnerable in a back alley. "No," Afton thought, "it's too easy." He got a sickening thought. It was delicious to him.

As Afton drove away, he saw his victim, skid marks, and crushed bones at the back of Freddy's. He felt no remorse, not like the five kids. Not like any of the other children he murdered. He felt happy and joyful. "She got what she deserved. She shouldn't have been inside in the rain." oh, he could just hear Henry weeping at the sight of her mangled body. "How does it feel, Henry? How does it feel to have someone you adore ripped away from you?! HOW DOES IT FEEL?!"

(Okay I want to get through this faster, so for the rest of this, I'm only going to be covering the major beats)

Afton has become the CEO of Fazbear Entertainment after Henry resigned out of grief. Good for him. With a little illegal action, of course. Who could stop him? He had just pulled out a loan to make a new pizzeria, one going back to his roots at Fall Fest but also themed around disco parties of the eighties and new technologies. However, just as the pizzeria began to open, he

couldn't help himself. The main animatronic suit, Circus Baby, doubled as a springlock suit, and Afton couldn't hold back and murdered the 30th batch of kids that he let in. Circus Baby's was closed almost immediately. He, as well as the company, lost a significant amount of revenue, but he didn't care. He was having so much fun and still had something of a comfortable home life. However, the public was done with Fazbear's. The company already was going down the tube, and the murders only made things worse. The worst part. Afton did not care anymore. He was still ecstatic about what he did. Enough so that he hadn't stopped smiling in days. And his daughter didn't even know. His Elizabeth. His favorite, and only child (he disowned Michael long ago). Until she wasn't. When Elizabeth was 9 years old, she ran away from Afton. And he was left alone. He was all alone. No one cared for him. No one in this world loved him anymore. All that was left was his greed and lust for death and murder. He was still killing. No one ever caught him. It was like God was letting him kill. And after some questionable methods to make people forget what had happened at Freddy's, Afton sold the company. He didn't remember to whom.

1997. He was tasked with emptying the original Freddy's pizzeria, where the five children were killed. He never killed anyone at Freddy's, except for them. They were the only ones he remembered killing. Afton saw the pizzeria with the lights off, he never realized how much of a dump this place was. It was moldy, and dry inside. It smelled of old pizza. Afton heard things. Things moving. Maybe rats got into the kitchen. And then he saw them. The kids he killed. Their faces pale, and wide, eyes gone, black liquid gushing from their sockets. And behind them, the animatronics. He shoved the bodies into the suits. The suits were moving on their own. No, no it can't be. Afton always had a theory, but....he never really got himself to believe it fully. He never believed in ghosts, but.....here they were. Ghosts possess their prisons. Afton's mind went wild as he thought of the implications this could have on his work. Imagine, souls that could be repurposed to bring the animatronics to life. Then Foxy started running towards him, screaming and thrashing violently. Afton ran, but he couldn't outrun it. He was cornered in the Backroom, where it all happened. The kids surrounded him, their faces happy that their killer was finally getting what he deserved. Afton, in a last attempt, threw on the old yellow Bonnie costume, conveniently in suit mode. Afton saw the kids shiver as they saw him. "Aww, what's the matter? Are you scared of a little bunny?" Afton laughed maniacally, and the springlocks snapped. He felt more pain than he ever felt before. Each spring snapping shut on his bones felt like each victim he killed, one by one, killing a piece of him. He screamed for help, with his shattered vocal cords, louder than he ever yelled before, but it wasn't enough. He turned around and saw Cassidy. He still sees Cassidy. She is stapled in his mind like a horrible dream. He shouldn't have killed that one.

Afton woke up dead. His soul possesses the thing He once felt so confident in. He pitched Henry the idea of the rabbit long ago. Henry. He hadn't even thought about his friend.

He missed him. What happened? What had he done?! How could he do something like this?! He loved children, how could he murder one?!

When a soul dies, its imperfections are stripped away, leaving it as pure as it once was. However, when a soul dies, but lives on in this world, the agony of the soul generates

undesirable things. Agony is what caused Charlie to merge with the puppet animatronic Henry made for her, allowing her to watch over the other children. It was agony that caused them to merge with the animatronics. Agony has properties that are supernatural at most. Afton has the most agony out of any of his victims. Killing has more agony than anything combined. Afton can now control this agony, making images, and nightmares at will. But at a terrible cost. The agony takes control of him. Making him the same monster that he was when he lived. And he lets it. The world will no longer accept, and love him. Not like his wife, not like his kids. If the world will only see him as a monster, he will play the part.

Afton is still wandering Hurricane, not alive, but not quite dead. He is mixed between a psychopathic monster and a hopeless, sorrowful man beyond saving. They have now merged. Only the monster remains. The man is abused by it. He doesn't even remember who he was. But the monster knows. The monster remembers it all. The joy of creation, and death. And they will burn it all to ash.

2015. In the world outside, the Afton family is seen as nothing less than a campfire story. A cautionary tale. The Afton house is still there. It hasn't been lived in since. Henry went to prison. He was convicted of being the killer, even though all of Hurricane knows the truth. The killer has also become a ghost story. Parents tell their kids not to go into the backrooms of restaurants or stores; otherwise, "The yellow rabbit will getcha." it was most popular around Halloween, especially. Enough so that PBS would make a story off of it. People were having fun about the tragedies that happened.

The children felt mocked.

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The Afton house looked sad, all the way over the hills. Afton was missing for years and was presumed dead. However, some said they still see the yellow rabbit out in the forest. Local teens found their way into the house. And while they came out alive, something scarred them. Something they saw. The police eventually decided to make an investigation of the house, and what they found was not what they expected. They found a basement, with all sorts of torturous devices. And while no bodies were found. Lots of strange things were there. The basement looked very pristine, despite being a torture chamber. And it seemed this was where Afton kept his junk. After finding a copy of Afton's journal, with very horrific things inside, the police concluded that Afton was the yellow rabbit. And Henry was set free.

Henry spent his 27 years in prison grieving, and was now a bitter man, a remnant of the once proud and optimistic man that once was. His wife died of grief a decade ago, and he was living in a not-so-shabby apartment. He never left the building. Where could he go? It seemed grief would always follow him. He spent his days in his apartment developing a plan. To avenge his daughter, and to find the murder, find Afton, if he was even still alive. There had been rumors of a yellow rabbit for a long time. Seen in sewer drains, and things like that. Though everyone

knew it was just a ghost story. That was until there were rumors of a new attraction opening. Fazbear's fright.

The talk of the murders, and Henry's release stirred up more popularity than ever for Freddy's. So much so that Hurricane was making a new attraction for Fall Fest, using the old Fredbear's family diner pizzeria as the building. Whilst Henry still hated the thought of mocking the murders that happened all those years ago, he was intrigued. He didn't even know if Afton was alive or not. This may prove it. There was a knock at the door. It was Micheal. Homeless, His face, still scarred from the beatings he received as a child. Still slightly purple, though still the funny, kind boy Henry knew those years ago. Michael told Henry that he had seen his daughter. Charlie had shown him that his father was still alive, and that the children who were murdered 30 years ago are not at rest. They are still angry, scared, and confused. Henry and Michael hatched a plan. To take it back to where it all began. (So my flashlight's on, and stay up till dawn...I'm sorry)  
2026 update: My sense of humor is something else...

The attraction opened. For the first few days, it was very well received. Until Afton broke in, and murdered a teen. His body was never found. The town was in a panic, however the local police assured everyone that it was just a weirdo who wanted to make the ghost story real, and that Afton was dead for years. They were lying to themselves. The attraction was closed, and was planning to reopen with better security, however. Until the place caught fire. And burned to the ground. Michael set the fire. Henry lured all the souls in there from the agony that began them. Michael saw his father one last time.

Afton was burned to ash. Ironic.

Henry burned to ash. A kind man forced to perish.

Michael burned to ash. He didn't deserve it.

It all ended in one snip of loose threads.

All so that they could finally be free.

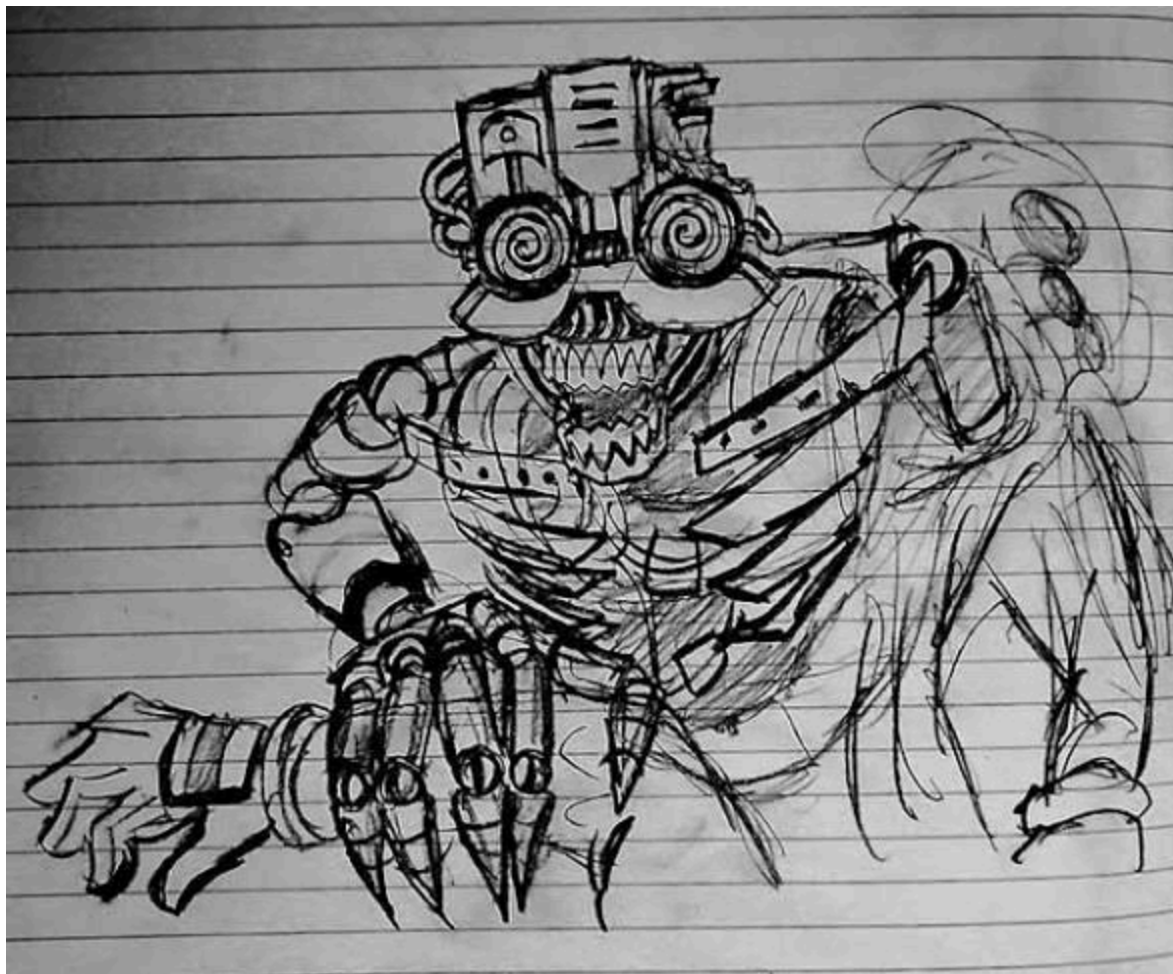
They are all free.

Except for me.

I am not free.

[illegible]





(art by Foxygamer 64)

so that was my very long rewrite of the FNAF timeline. If you made it to the end, Congratulations. Thank you so much for reading it all. Please send me feedback so I can improve it later on, and.....I'm going to take a nap.